Touchline Coach Guide

Step by step, for Tim and Deano.
Match day and training, the two jobs we are relied on for.

Wigan Junior Latics U15 Blues

Version 1, October 2026. Screenshots use made up demo players. Coaches only: do not share this guide with parents or players.

How to use this guide

Open Touchline on your phone, keep this guide beside you, and follow the numbers. Every red number on a screenshot matches a step next to it.

Tim

Builds the block, publishes the week, picks the side, runs the live match, writes the review.

Deano

Opens Tonight, leads his named practice from the run card, ticks attendance, runs the clock and subs if Tim asks.

Safeguarding. Shirt numbers only in anything parents or players see. No ability bands, scores or rankings. Notes on lads stay in Team, coaches only.

The bottom bar

Tab	What it is for
Today	Your first stop. Next match, tonight's session, checklist, what needs you.
Match	Fixtures, availability, the side, the live clock, results.
Team	Squad cards, team builder, minutes, welfare. Coaches only.
Train	Plan, Run and Library. Three buttons across the top, then a row of pages under them.
Comms	Hub (what parents and players see), referees, Ask, More (codes and settings).

Train in one picture

Top button	Pages underneath	Use it to
Plan	Build, This week, Attendance, Reflect	Build the block, publish the week, mark who came, review the night.
Run	Tonight, Session, Animations, Board, Fitness	Coach from the grass: run card, practices, animations, tactics board.
Library	Sessions, Resources, Instagram, X posts, Listen, Clips	Reuse sessions and find practices.

A normal week

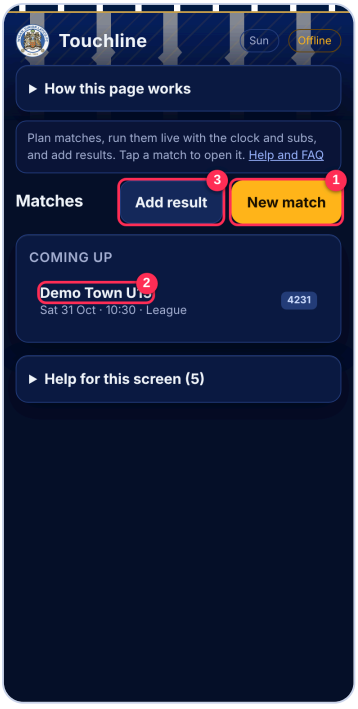
When	Who	Job
Sunday	Tim	Check the week in Train, Plan, Build. Share it to parents and players. Make the run card. Tell Deano the session is ready.
Monday	Tim	Send the push alert for training. Players and parents answer Yes, No or Maybe.
Wednesday 18:30	Both	Today: tick the checklist. Open Tonight. Check who is coming.
Wednesday 19:00 to 20:00	Both	Run the session. Deano leads his practice. Tick attendance as lads arrive.
Wednesday after	Tim	Reflect: who stood out, one sentence for Saturday.
Thursday	Tim	Post the match to parents and ask who is available.
Friday	Tim	Pull in the answers, pick the side, send Team is up when ready.
Saturday	Both	Match day checklist, kick off reminder, run the live match, Full time, result.

Part 1. Match day

Everything for Saturday lives in the Match tab. Nothing reaches parents until you post it.

Before you start: what must be in place

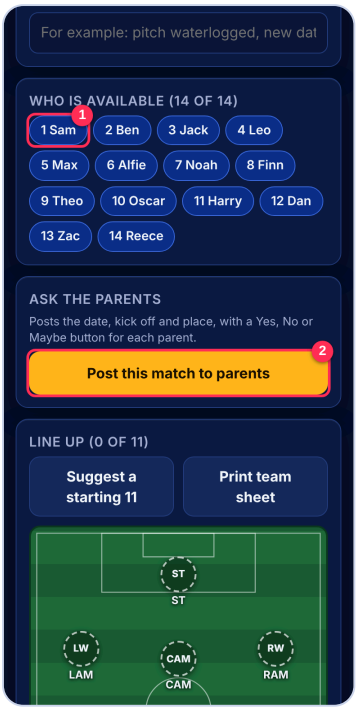
- All lads are in Team, Squad with a shirt number and at least one position.
- FAN numbers are added on each lad's card (needed for the FA squad list).
- The coach code is on your phone and you are signed in as Tim or Deano (Comms, More).



1. Create the match

1. (1) Tap **New match**.
2. Fill in the opponent, date, kick off time, home or away, the league or cup, and half length (35 minutes at this age).
3. (2) Your match now sits under **Coming up**. Tap it to open it any time.
4. (3) **Add result** is for games already played.

Postponed? Open the match, use the Postponed box, add a note for parents.



2. Ask who is available

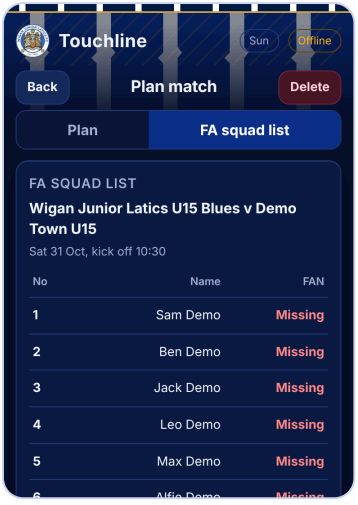
1. (1) Open the match and scroll to **Who is available**. Tap a lad to cycle yes, no, unsure. Use it for what you already know (injured, away).
2. (2) Tap **Post this match to parents**. Parents and players now see the game on their Home page and answer Yes, No or Maybe.
3. Later, tap **Pull in answers** to bring their replies into your list. Check the numbers before you pick.
4. **Take it down** removes the post if details change.

Selection comes from the availability poll and the training review, not a hunch on a Thursday night.



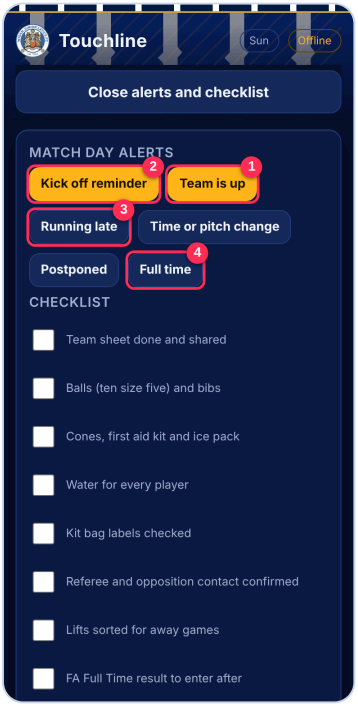
3. Pick the side

1. (1) Tap **Suggest a starting 11**. It uses who is in, positions and minutes so far. You can change anything.
2. Tap a position on the pitch, then tap the lad you want. The list shows who fits best.
3. Check the **Subs** list and the minutes bars. Every lad should start and finish games across the block.
4. (2) **Print team sheet** gives a copy for the referee.
5. (3) **Start match** goes live. Only press it at kick off.



4. FA squad list

1. In the match, tap the **FA squad list** button beside Plan.
2. Check every lad shows a FAN number. Missing ones show in red: add them on the lad's card in Team, Squad.
3. Tap **Print or PDF** to give to the referee and the other manager. Coaches only, never on the parents page.

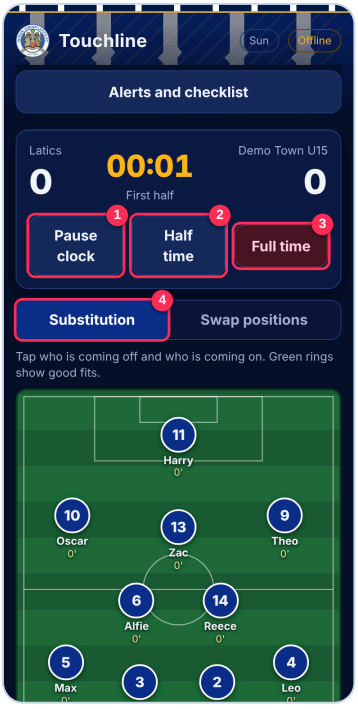


5. Alerts and checklist

Open **Alerts and checklist** at the top of the match.

1. (1) **Team is up** tells parents the side is on the page.
2. (2) **Kick off reminder** for the morning.
3. (3) **Running late**, **Time or pitch change** and **Postponed** are for problems.
4. (4) **Full time** sends the result alert.
5. Tick the match day checklist as you do each job: team sheet, balls and bibs, first aid kit, water, kit bag labels, ref and opposition contact, lifts, FA Full Time result.

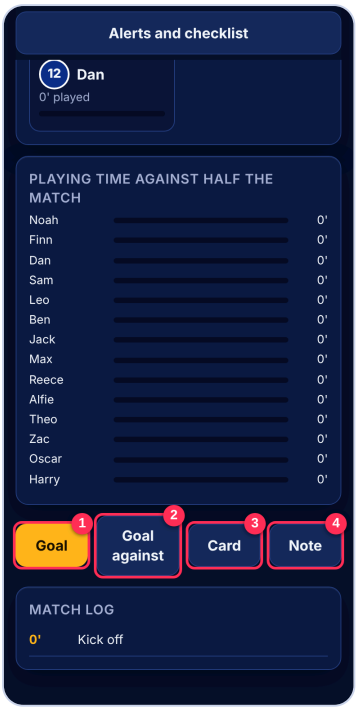
An alert goes to every parent phone that has turned alerts on. Think before you press.



6. Run the live match

1. 1 **Pause clock** and resume it for injuries.
2. 2 **Half time**, then **Start second half**.
3. 3 **Full time** ends the game.
4. 4 Substitution: tap who comes off on the pitch, then who comes on from the bench. The playing time bars update. **Swap positions** moves two lads on the pitch.

The sub reminder fires every 17 minutes by default so nobody sits too long.



7. Log what happens

1. 1 **Goal**: pick the scorer and assist.
2. 2 **Goal against**.
3. 3 **Card**.
4. 4 **Note**: type a quick note about a lad or the game.
5. **Undo last** takes back a wrong tap. The **Match log** below keeps the timeline.

After the whistle

1. Tap **Full time**. The match moves to its summary.
2. **Man of the match** is shown to parents and players, so pick it fairly.
3. **Copy for WhatsApp** gives a ready written summary.
4. Enter the result on FA Full Time, then run a Reflect (Part 2, step 9).

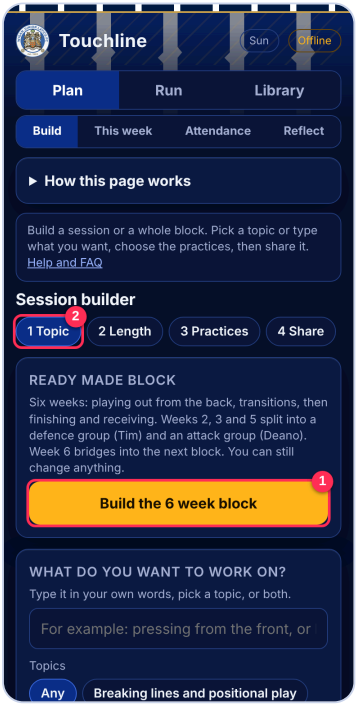
If the signal drops. The app saves on the phone first and syncs later. Keep logging. The Offline badge at the top turns off when it catches up.

Part 2. Training

Wednesday 19:00 to 20:00 on one third of a 4G pitch. Fifty five minutes of football, five for set up and the review.

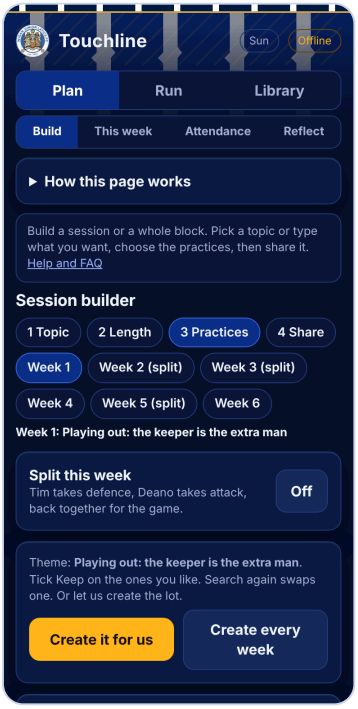
Before you start: what must be in place

- A block is built in Train, Plan, Build (six weeks, week six bridges to the next block).
- The run card is made for the week (step 4).
- The week is shared to parents and players (step 5).
- Deano has seen his named practice before Wednesday.



1. Plan the block

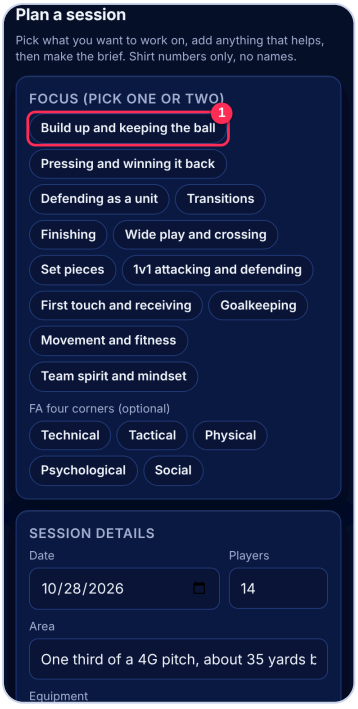
1. Train, then **Plan**, then **Build**.
2. 1 **Build the 6 week block** is the ready made block. It has the theme, the practices, and weeks 2, 3 and 5 as splits.
3. 2 Or work through the tabs: **1 Topic**, **2 Length**, **3 Practices**, **4 Share**.
4. Pick a topic or type your own words. The last week bridges into the next block topic.



2. Fill each week

1. On **3 Practices**, tap a week (Week 1 to Week 6). Weeks marked **split** have Tim on defence and Deano on attack.
2. **Create it for us** fills the week. **Create every week** fills all six.
3. On each practice tap **Keep** if you like it, **Search again** to swap it, or **Find my own** to pick from Resources.
4. Check who leads. Deano always has one named practice.
5. Tap **Next: review and share**.

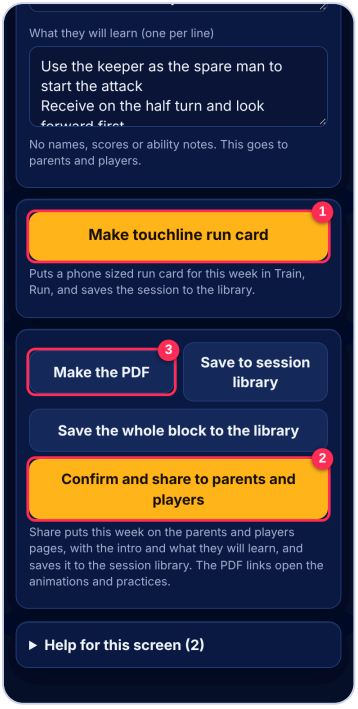
The groups for the night are mixed on purpose. Tap **Mix them again** for a new set. No ability bands.



3. One off plan (Train, Plan, This week)

1. 1 Pick a focus (one or two) and, if you like, an FA four corners tag.
2. Check date, number of players, area and kit. Add anything to help the plan.
3. Tap **Make the brief**. Use **Copy** or **Open in Claude** to send it for a full session plan.

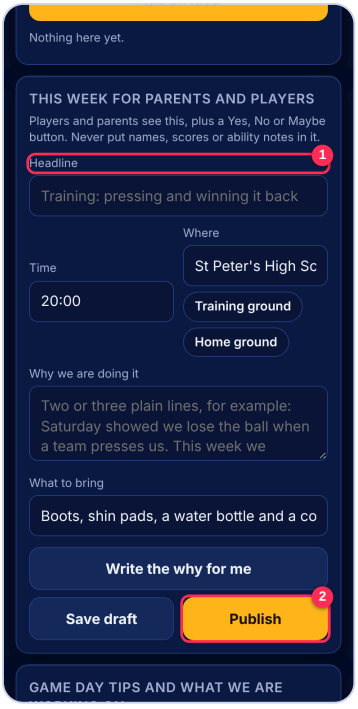
Use this when you want a session outside the block.



4. Make the run card and share

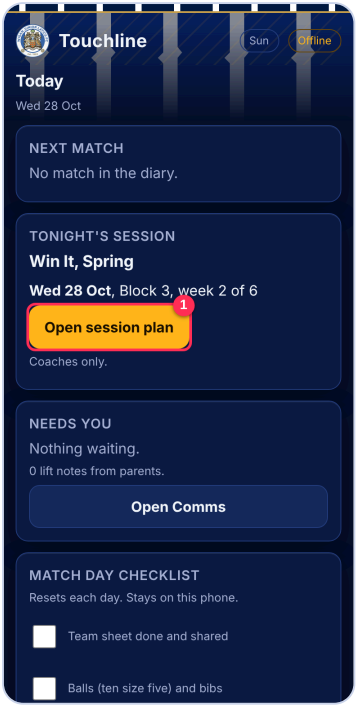
1. 1 **Make touchline run card** builds the phone sized plan you coach from on the grass.
2. 3 **Make the PDF** prints the plan with a QR code to the animation.
3. 2 **Confirm and share to parents and players** puts the week on their Home pages with the intro and what they will learn.
4. After sharing, two more buttons appear: **Send a push alert to parents** and **Send a push alert to the players**.

Check the intro line and the learning points first. No names, scores or ability notes.



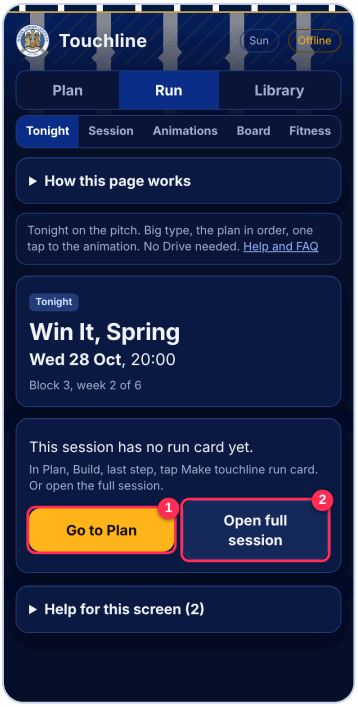
5. Post to parents and players, and ask who is coming

1. Train, Plan, **This week**, scroll to **This week for parents and players**.
2. 1 Write the **Headline**, time, where (training ground or home ground), why we are doing it, and what to bring. **Write the why for me** drafts it.
3. 2 **Publish** (or **Update and publish**). Players and parents see it and answer Yes, No or Maybe.
4. Further down, **Who is coming** shows the answers. Tap **Refresh answers**, then **Use Yes count** to set the player number for the plan.
5. **Take it down** removes it. **Print or PDF** gives a copy.



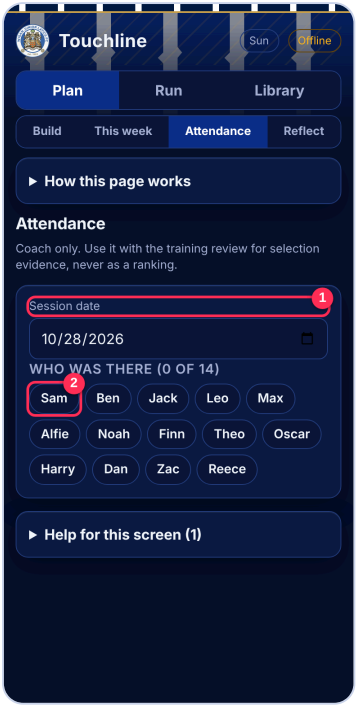
6. Wednesday: start on Today

1. Open **Today** at 18:30.
2. 1 **Open session plan** shows tonight's session. Coaches only.
3. Tick the match day checklist items that apply, and check **Needs you** for anything parents or players have asked.
4. Check the welfare and knocks list. A lad with growth pain loses jumping and repeated sprints that week.



7. Run the night: Tonight

1. Train, **Run**, **Tonight**.
2. The card shows the title, the date and the block week. If you see *This session has no run card yet*, tap **Go to Plan** and make it (step 4).
3. 2 **Open full session** gives every practice in order with who leads, the three coaching points and two questions for each.
4. Deano's practice shows **Deano says**: the words to use, in plain English.
5. Tap **Play** on a practice to watch its animation.



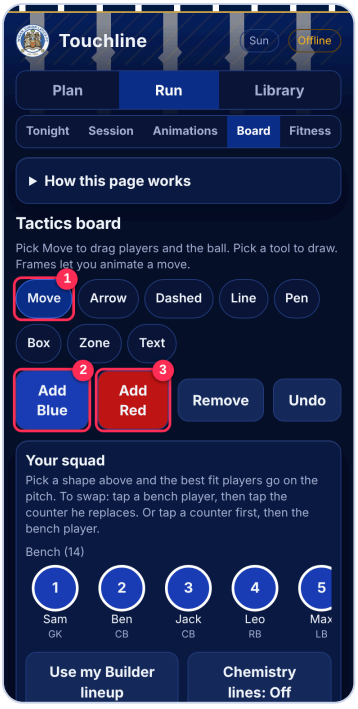
8. Attendance

1. Train, **Plan**, **Attendance**.
2. 1 Check the session date.
3. 2 Tap each lad as he walks on. A highlighted name means he is here. Tap again to undo.
4. It takes under a minute. Do it while the arrival activity runs.
5. It is evidence for selection and load. It is never a ranking.

9. Reflect (Train, Plan, Reflect)

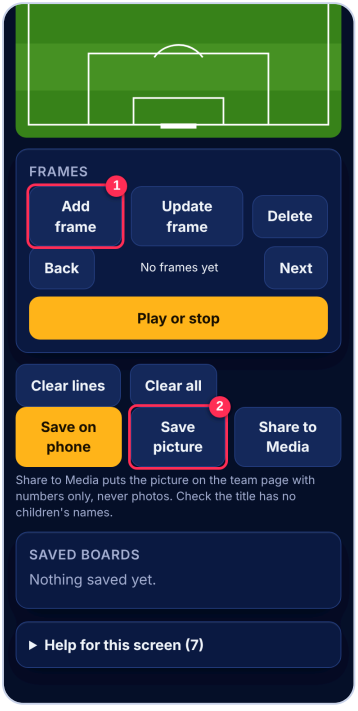
1. Do it the same night while it is fresh.
2. Answer the few questions, tick the four corners you saw, add welfare notes, and note who stood out.
3. Write one sentence on what we try on Saturday. This feeds next week's selection.

Part 3. Board, animations and 3D



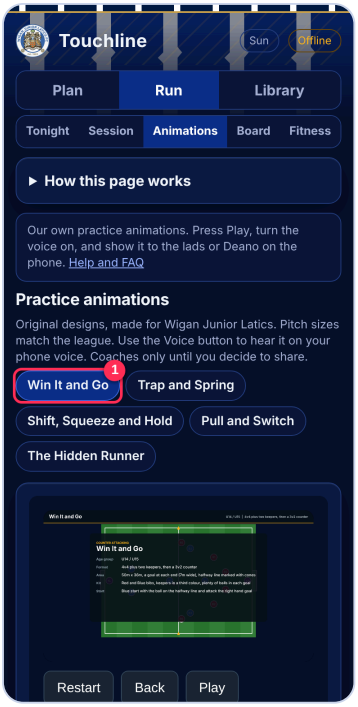
1. Use the tactics board

1. Train, **Run**, **Board**.
2. (1) Pick a tool: **Move** (drag players and the ball), **Arrow**, **Dashed**, **Line**, **Pen**, **Box**, **Zone**, **Text**.
3. (2) **Add Blue** and (3) **Add Red** place a player. Use **Remove** and **Undo** to tidy.
4. Pick a colour. Choose a team shape from the dropdowns to drop a full set in place.
5. **Your squad** lets you drop real lads in by number. **Use my Builder lineup** brings in Saturday's side.
6. Pick a pitch size or load your own image under **Pitch**.



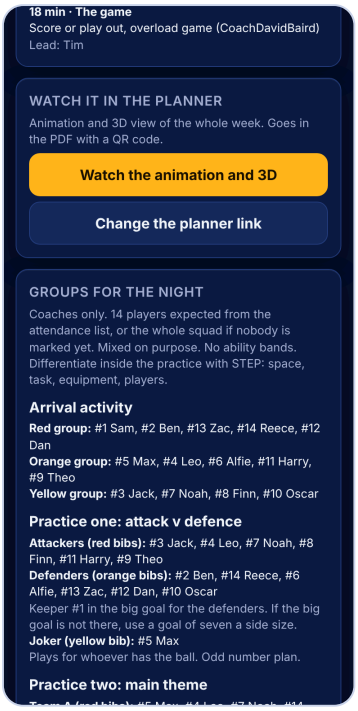
2. Frames, save and share

1. (1) **Add frame** saves the current picture as step one. Move the players, then **Add frame** again for step two. Use **Update frame** to correct one.
2. **Play or stop** runs the frames as a simple animation. **Back** and **Next** step through.
3. (2) **Save picture** saves a PNG to your phone. **Save on phone** keeps the board in **Saved boards**.
4. **Share to Media** puts it on the team page after you approve it. No children's names.
5. **Clear lines** keeps the players. **Clear all** wipes the board.



3. Watch the practice animations

1. Train, **Run**, **Animations**.
2. (1) Pick a practice (Win It and Go, Trap and Spring, and so on).
3. (2) Tap **Play**. **Restart** and **Back** are under the picture. Turn the voice on to hear it. Slow it down to show a coaching point.
4. Read the **Set up**, **Rules** and coaching points under the picture.
5. Use it to show Deano or the lads what a practice looks like before you start.

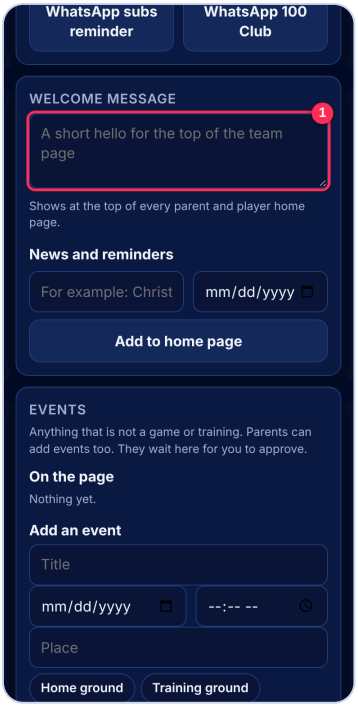


4. Animation and 3D for the whole week

1. Train, **Plan**, **Build**, **Next: review and share**.
2. The **Watch it in the planner** card holds the link to the week's animation and 3D view in Sport Session Planner.
3. If a link exists tap **Watch the animation and 3D**. It opens in your browser. The same link goes in the PDF as a QR code.
4. If not, tap **Add the planner link** and paste the link for the week.
5. **To request one**: draw the week in Sport Session Planner (or ask Claude in the Latics project to build it from the session plan), then paste the link here. Link each practice too using **Planner link** on the practice card.

Only paste links you trust. Weeks 3 to 6 may not have links yet, so expect the note "No planner link for this week yet".

Part 4. Posting to parents and players



The Hub

1. Comms, **Hub**. It controls what parents and players see on Home.
2. 1 **Welcome message** is the short hello at the top of the team page. Add events and news and reminders below it.
3. Approve events and pictures that parents post. Nothing shows until you approve it.
4. Check lifts and contacts. Send phone alerts only when you need to.
5. **Add subs reminder to news** and **Add 100 Club to news** put the reminders on Home. The WhatsApp buttons make the text to paste.

I want to tell...	Where	Button
Everyone about training	Train, Plan, This week	Publish
Everyone about the block week	Train, Plan, Build, review and share	Confirm and share to parents and players
Everyone about a match	Match, open the match	Post this match to parents
Everyone the side is up	Match, Alerts and checklist	Team is up
Everyone something general	Comms, Hub	Welcome message, news
Only players about training	Train, Plan, Build, after sharing	Send a push alert to the players

Part 5. Quick fixes

Problem	Try this
Offline badge stays on	You are out of signal. Keep working. It syncs when you are back.
Old version of the app	Close it fully and reopen. If still old, clear the site data in your browser settings.
No run card for tonight	Train, Plan, Build, review and share, tap Make touchline run card.
Lad missing from lists	Team, Squad: check he is marked active and has a shirt number.
FAN number missing	Team, Squad, tap the lad, add it, then reprint the FA squad list.
Parent cannot get in	Comms, More: check the parent and player codes. Never share the coach code.
Alert sent by mistake	Send a short follow up alert straight away. Tell Tim.

Keep it safe. The coach code is for Tim and Deano only. Sign out of shared phones in Comms, More. If a phone is lost, tell Tim at once so codes can be changed. If a button in the app does not match this guide, tell Tim and the guide will be updated.